

Current-State Assessment

Meridian Group Data Platform Consolidation

Data landscape

Each entity's data lives in its own set of spreadsheets, formatted its own way. None of the three agree on date format or how payment terms get written down, which sounds trivial until you're the one trying to merge them.

Entity	Date format	Payment terms notation
Meridian North	YYYY-MM-DD	"Net 30"
Meridian West	MM/DD/YYYY	"30 days"
Meridian Coastal	DD-Mon-YYYY	"N30"

Vendor master

31 vendor records across the three entities resolve down to only 18 distinct real vendors. Just under half of the legacy rows (13 of 31) are cross-entity duplicates of a vendor that already exists somewhere else in the group, each with its own local ID and no cross-reference back to the others. Active/inactive status disagrees across entities for most of the vendors that are shared, which tracks: there has never been a single place recording it.

Invoices

Before go-live, about one invoice in five is missing its PO reference or is a duplicate entry. Average time from invoice date to paid date runs 43–46 days, well past the 30-day terms most vendors are actually on.

Reconciliation

Bank transactions get matched to invoices by manual lookup. Matched items take about 46 days on average to close, and there's a standing backlog of paid invoices with no confirmed bank transaction behind them — nobody has a running count of how large that backlog actually is at any given time.

Reporting

There's no consolidated view. Any cross-entity report means opening three spreadsheets and reconciling naming and ID differences by hand, which is the same underlying problem as the data itself, one level up.

Root causes

- 1 No shared vendor identity across entities — each spreadsheet is its own island.
- 2 No validation gate at vendor setup, so a defect only surfaces when a payment fails or is delayed.

- 3 Reconciliation is manual line-matching rather than exception-based, so every item gets the same level of manual attention whether or not it actually needs it.
- 4 No unified data model, so every report is a one-off manual roll-up.